



# Montenegro



Perched on the Adriatic coast, this tiny republic became a separate state in 2006, after 88 years of federation with its neighbors in various forms of the state of Yugoslavia.



## GEOGRAPHY

A narrow coastal strip on the Adriatic. Fertile lowland plains around Lake Scutari. Mountainous interior with deep canyons.



## CLIMATE

The lowlands have hot, dry summers and mild winters. Heavy snow in winter in the mountains.



## PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Most Montenegrins are Orthodox Christians. They speak a language closely related to Serbian, using the same Cyrillic script. Muslim Albanians, who make up 80% of the population of the southern Ulcinj region, supported independence and are now asking for autonomy.



**INSIGHT:** Dark forests once cloaked Montenegro's mountains; its name means "Black Mountain"



## THE ECONOMY

Tourism (along Adriatic) drives growth. Bauxite reserves, aluminum industry. Economy dominated by black market; cigarette smuggling is rife. Return of foreign aid and investment. The 2007 accord with the EU is the first step toward eventual accession.



## FACTFILE

**OFFICIAL NAME:** Republic of Montenegro

**DATE OF FORMATION:** 2006

**CAPITAL:** Podgorica

**POPULATION:** 624,200

**TOTAL AREA:** 5332 sq. miles  
(13,812 sq. km)

**DENSITY:** 117 people per sq. mile

**LANGUAGES:** Montenegrin\*, Serbian, Albanian

**RELIGIONS:** Orthodox Christian 74%, Muslim 18%, Catholic 4%, other 4%

**ETHNIC MIX:** Montenegrin 43%, Serb 32%, other 12%, Bosniak 8%, Albanian 5%

**GOVERNMENT:** Parliamentary system

**CURRENCY:** Euro = 100 cents